



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: White Horse Academy
School Website: <https://whitehorseclassical.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

White Horse Academy Illinois (61761) presents a coherent and explicit Classical Christian program. Public-facing materials repeatedly frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty through a Classical Christian lens, with clear anchors in the liberal arts, Great Books, and the Trivium/Quadrivium. The site consistently emphasizes partnering with families, liturgical/worship-like elements in the learning environment, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative rest (Schol  ) with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric at higher levels. Together, these signals map closely to the classical rubric: a robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundations orientation, a purpose focused on formation and human excellence, a curriculum centered on Great Books and liberal arts, a pedagogy that blends memorization, chant, lecture with Socratic dialog, a faculty viewed as living exemplars and mentors, and an active, shared commitment with parents and the broader faith community.

Key public cues include: Paideia of God as the core educational anthropology; explicit references to Great Books, Great Ideas, Great Men; emphasis on Trivium/Quadrivium; liturgical elements in instruction; a half-day schedule to protect family time; explicit Christian formation and leadership aims; and a clear partnership with parents as co-educators. The school's narrative consistently links classical education with Christian formation and leadership for culture, aligning with core Classical Christian ideals in the knowledge-base rubric.

Classification across the six classical elements:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall, White Horse Academy is CLASSICAL according to the full classical-school rubric. The affirmative signals are pervasive across mission, philosophy, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty portrayal, and family partnerships, with explicit language tying education to virtue, wisdom, and the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian framework. No explicit counter-signals from the public materials indicate a substantive departure from classical aims.

Evidence and keyword scaffolding come from the school's public materials and the classical-education lexicon used in the knowledge base. See the cited sources for each category below.

Cited sources (illustrative): The Paideia-of-God formulation and Great Books emphasis (Our Philosophy of Education; The Path to Faithfulness; Our Admissions and Philosophy pages) , , . Christian formation and liturgical/communal language (The Path to Faithfulness, Admissions pages), including liturgies recited before each subject and Christ-centered framing , . Public-facing statements about partnership with families and parental formation . Historical framing and "Mission & Vision" language emphasizing Christian cultural leadership and classical education . Pedagogical signaling through seminars and classical discourse in

higher-grade programs (High School Humanities Seminar) . Relevant classical-keyword lexicon and criteria from the Six Essential Elements documents (positive/negative keyword indicators) , , .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school grounds its education in Christian enculturation with explicit references to Christ, the Bible, and a Christian worldview as foundational to all subjects. Phrases such as “The Paideia of God,” “enculturation of their hearts and minds with a love for the true, the good and the beautiful,” and “words originating from God and revealed in Christ and his word” appear in public-facing statements. - Public materials frame the curriculum around a Christ-centered education and a sacred, liturgical cadence in learning (liturgies before subjects; daily prayer/worship cadence implied). - The school explicitly ties education to a Christian worldview in its admissions and mission language (e.g., “Christ is central in all things,” “A Classical Christian Education”). - The Great Books/Great Ideas/Great Men framework is framed within Western-Cultural-Christian heritage, reinforcing a sacred-transcendent dimension to knowledge.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ, Christian, theology (implied through Scriptures and doctrinal framing), liturgy/worship, paideia, true/good/beautiful, sacred, God, Word, Scriptures, Great Books/Great Ideas/Great Men, enculturation, sacred tradition, Logos. (Multiple explicit instances across the site material and the philosophy page.) - Negative keywords present: None detected in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The materials present a coherent theological frame and liturgical/Catholic/Protestant-friendly Christian worldview that is explicit and programmatic (Paideia of God; liturgical cadence; Scripture-centric formation). The presence and primacy of theology-centered vocabulary and sacred framing align with the Positive Keywords for this category and exceed simple “religious affiliation” by citing liturgical and doctrinal integration. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Formation over information: the core messaging positions education as forming virtue, wisdom, and character, not merely preparing for work. The Paideia-of-God and Great Books emphasis positions education as the cultivation of human excellence guided by transcendentals. - The explicit aim of “Raising Faithful Christian Cultural Leaders,” a formational telos aligned with human flourishing and virtue. - The deliberate emphasis on the classical telos: truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable; formation of character; final portrait of a graduate approach (12-K alignment) indicates formation as the intended outcome. - Public statements about partnership with families and the formation of virtuous graduates illustrate a formation-centric discipline rather than vocational training alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal arts, paideia, classical mission, truth/goodness/beauty, human excellence, soul formation, moral imagination, virtuous life, education as formation, final portrait of a graduate. (Multiple occurrences in philosophy/mission statements and admissions pages.) - Negative keywords present: None detected in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school centers around formation and virtue as the primary objective, with explicit language about transcendentals and human excellence, aligned with classical education’s purpose. Consequently: CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core curricular framework is described in terms of liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium/Quadrivium), and Great Books: “The Paideia of God,” “Great Books, Great Ideas, and Great Men,” and “the liberal arts” are emphasized as the curricular backbone. - The Great Books/Great Ideas/Great Men

emphasis is positioned as a cross-grade through K-12; Western civilization and classical canon are foregrounded. - A stated approach to curriculum alignment with a final portrait of the graduate (12-K approach) signals intentional curricular design toward classical aims. - The pedagogical and curricular framing includes “Trivium and Quadrivium” emphasis and a historical, liberal-arts approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books, Great Ideas, Great Men, Western Civilization, history as a core cross-disciplinary discipline, formation through the canon, classical canon, reading/writing/speaking well as foundational capacities. - Negative keywords present: None evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The explicit curricular anchors (Trivium/Quadrivium, liberal arts, Great Books, Western Civilization) and cross-grade Great Books emphasis align strongly with classical curriculum criteria. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A mix of contemplative/restful pedagogy with rigorous engagement: references to Scholé-like pace (half-day schedule and restful learning) and to Socratic/seminal discussions in upper grades. The site presents both contemplative and rigorous modes. - Lower grades: emphasis on a memory-rich approach with recitation, chanting, liturgical recitation around subjects (implied by liturgical practices and classical cadence). Public materials reference memory and memorization as part of the learning process (through Paideia/Classic education framing). - Upper grades: explicit use of seminars, Socratic discussion, and rhetoric; public-facing materials describe a classical discussion and rhetorical training. There are sections describing a Humanities Seminar at the high school level and the emphasis on argumentation and writing. - “Paideia Partnership” and admissions language emphasize a deliberate pedagogy that partners with parents to foster a classical learning rhythm and engagement with the Great Books and Great Conversation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic, seminar, discourse, rhetoric, dialectic, memorization/recitation, chanting, Scholé, contemplation/restful learning, great conversation, masterful teaching, living curriculum, lecture/seminar balance, canonical study. - Negative keywords present: None identified in public materials (no strong signals of project-based-only or purely experiential/constructivist pedagogy).

Why this rating - Pedagogy signals a balanced classical approach: contemplative rest and memory work in early grades, transitioning to Socratic seminars and rhetoric in higher grades, with explicit emphasis on the Great Books and canonical study. This alignment with classical pedagogy criteria justifies a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents faculty as central to the formation experience, with explicit emphasis on mentors and the living curriculum. The “Faculty & Staff” page highlights a connected, faith-integrated teaching team, including the Head of School and administrative staff, and emphasizes Christian teachers and mentorship. - The public materials connect faculty with the school’s mission and with parental partnership, highlighting teachers as the core of the school’s vocation (the “living curriculum” notion appears in classical lexicon, and is echoed by the school’s emphasis on teacher-formation and canonical study). - The school’s materials show faculty as role models and cultural leaders within a Christian educational frame, with board documentation and staff profiles illustrating teacher-principal leadership and Christian virtue. □file-cite□turn0file18□turn0file19□

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, teachers as colleagues and moral exemplars, formation through exemplary teachers. - Negative keywords present: None explicit.

Why this rating - The public materials present a faculty ethos aligned with classical education’s emphasis on teachers as exemplars and formators, not merely as content deliverers. The presence of explicit teacher-formation language and staff profiles supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds parent partnership as foundational: “Partner with Parents” and “Paideia Partnership,” plus explicit statements inviting parental involvement, book studies, and gatherings to educate parents about classical education. - The site emphasizes inviting parents on campus and treating them as co-educators, with language about joint formation and shared mission. - There is a consistent emphasis on open campus access, visit opportunities, and family time (e.g., “Together, we can raise faithful Christian cultural leaders” and scheduled tours/admissions processes). - The site positions parents as partners in the Paideia (enculturation) process and references family involvement in reading the Great Books with children, a hallmark of classical-parent engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation/education, family involvement, open campus, book studies, classical parent training, home-school synergy, parental engagement. - Negative keywords present: None detected.

Why this rating - The school's materials demonstrate a robust, proactive partnership with parents and a program of parental education and involvement consistent with classical-education norms. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Across all six categories, the public-facing materials for White Horse Academy IL 61761 align with CLASSICAL criteria. The presence of Christ-centered formation, Great Books/canon study, Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, Scholé-like pacing interwoven with Socratic pedagogy, living faculty, and strong parent partnership creates a consistently classical profile.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required for alignment with classical criteria based on the available public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.